

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Lion

⚠ IUCN status: vulnerable

👤 Population estimate: 20,000–32,000

KEY

🟩 Lion range

Between desert and forest

Lions are scarcer in western Africa, and survive only in patches of grassland between the Sahara Desert further north and thick coastal forests to the south.

Forest clearings

Only in the Congo Basin do lions come close to thick rainforest. Here, small numbers survive in patches of grassland in forest clearings.

Desert home

Lions can roam far into the driest deserts, getting much of the water they need from the prey they catch and even from eating wild melons.

Historic range

More than 2,000 years ago, lions were much more widespread, ranging northward into Europe and as far east as India. But as the human population has grown, lions' native habitats have been taken for human settlement, agriculture, and livestock.

Lion

This big cat is second in size only to the tiger. It is known as the king of the jungle, but in fact lives in the open grasslands and savannas of Africa, where it is superbly adapted to hunting. Unlike most cats, which are solitary hunters, lions work together as a group, or pride, to bring down prey.



THE ROAR OF AN ADULT MALE LION IS SO LOUD THAT IT CAN BE HEARD CLEARLY UP TO 5 MILES (8 KM) AWAY

